

Katharina Klaunig
katharina.klaunig@unc.edu

Education

- Expected 2028 Ph.D. in Sociology, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
Comprehensive Exams in Migration and Social Stratification
- 2023 - present Population Science Predoctoral Trainee, Carolina Population Center
- 2025 M.A. in Sociology, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
Thesis: "Tradeoffs in Absence and Presence: Does Current or Return Migration Matter More for Migration in Nepal?"
- 2021 B.A. in Social Research and Public Policy, New York University Abu Dhabi
Minors: Economics, Arabic
Thesis: "Are All Migrants Similarly Mobile? The Role of Pre-Migration Context for Mobility in the UAE Labor Market."

Peer-Reviewed Papers and Papers under Review

Klaunig, Katharina and Barbara Entwisle. 2026 (forthcoming). Migration and the Life Course in the Context of Social Change. *R & R at Comparative Population Studies*.

Klaunig, Katharina, Saba Karim Klan, and Malte Reichelt. 2024. "My life is not to be called failure": Family Expectations, Reputation, and Migration Decisions. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies* 50(20): 5127–5146. <https://doi.org/10.1080/1369183X.2024.2346179>

Honors and Awards

- NICHD T-32 Predoctoral Traineeship, Population Science | 2024-2026
- Visiting Fellowship for Young Scholars | Akademie für Soziologie | 2025
- Short-term Research Grant | German Academic Exchange Services (DAAD) | 2023
- Post-graduation Research Fellowship | Hilary Ballon Center for Teaching & Learning | 2021-2022
- US State Dept. Language Scholarship | National Security Language Initiative for Youth | 2016

Conference Presentations

2026. "Migration and the Life Course in the Context of Social Change" Poster presented at the Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, St. Louis, MO, USA. (with Barbara Entwisle)

- *Poster Award*

2025. "Current Versus Past Migration: Which Matters More for Migration in Nepal?" Paper presented at the 5th Forum of the International Sociological Association, Rabat, Morocco.

2025. "The Differential Roles of Migration Exposures in the Timing of Migration." Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, Washington, DC.

2024. "'My life is not to be called a failure': Family Expectations, Reputation, and Migration

Decisions." Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Montreal, Canada. (with Saba Karim Khan and Malte Reichelt)

2024. "Organizational Faultlines and Labor Market Mobility in Germany." Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, Columbus, OH, USA. (with Malte Reichelt)

2023. "Social incorporation and transnationalism among Chinese immigrants in the U.S.: results from a network survey." Presented at the Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Philadelphia, PA, USA. (with Ted Mouw and Giovanna Merli)

Teaching

Instructor of Record | Research Methods | UNC | Fall 2026

Teaching Assistant | Research Methods | UNC | Spring 2024

Teaching Assistant | Social Relations in the Workplace | UNC | Spring 2023; Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant | Economy and Society | UNC | Fall 2022

Professional Experience

Associate Editor | Social Forces | 2025 - 2027

Research Assistant | Dr. Lisa Pearce | Mothers' Religiosity in the context of Sons' Migration in the Chitwan Valley | 2024-2025

Research Assistant | Dr. Anna Lunn, Charlotte Wang, and Dr. Peter Bearman | Research and Empirical Analysis of Labor Migration | 2019 - 2020

Service to the Profession

PhD Network Board Member | IMISCOE (International Migration Research Network) | 2024 -

Ad Hoc Reviewer | International Migration Review; Discover Global Society

Session Chair | IMISCOE Spring Conference | 2026

Session Chair | Population Association of America | 2025

University Service

Co-President | Sociology Graduate Student Association | UNC | 2024 - 2026

Coordinator | Migration Working Group | UNC | 2023 - 2025

Committee Member | Provost Graduate Student Advisory Committee | UNC | 2024 - 2025

Professional Memberships

American Sociological Association

Population Association of America

International Sociological Association

Akademie für Soziologie

Additional Skills and Training

Programming and Analysis Tools

Stata	Proficient
R	Proficient
Python	Basic
Qualtrics	Proficient
MaxQDA	Proficient
Atlas.ti	Proficient

Courses

Rethinking Rural Futures in an Age of Climate Change: Migration, Adaptation, and Sustainability Transitions | Venice International University | 2025

Topics in Digital and Computational Demography | Max Plack Institue for Demographic Research | 2023

Languages

English	Native
German	Fluent, Heritage
Dutch	Advanced - NT2 certificate
Arabic	Intermediate